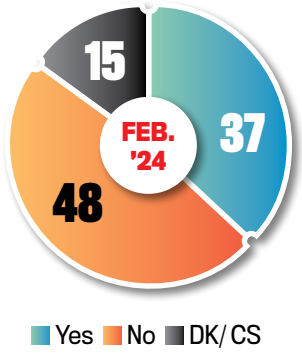
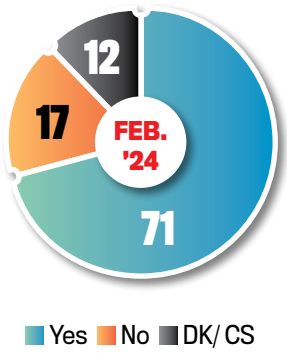
Q. Will Nitish Kumar's exit from I.N.D.I.A. help NDA achieve its target of 400+ Lok Sabha seats?



Close to a majority say the Nitish factor alone can't help NDA go past 400 seats

Q. By constantly switching alliances, has Nitish hurt his image permanently?



Having changed allies several times in the past decade, most feel Nitish has hurt his image

All figures in % and rounded off

The Modi-Shah duo, on the other hand, is not given to complacency, and works tirelessly to win elections, and weaken their opponents elsewhere. This could mean even breaking Opposition coalitions that can pose a significant threat, like in Maharashtra and in Bihar, apart from setting the Enforcement Directorate (ED) after rival Opposition leaders to pursue corruption charges. As many as 46 per cent of the respondents believe that the BJP government has misused enforcement agencies such as the ED, Central Bureau of Investigation and the income-tax department more than any other government in the past. But one thing overrides all else: Brand Modi. The prime minister has masterfully converted the 2024 Lok Sabha election into a referendum on his leadership and performance. If Modi wins a third consecutive term, as the MOTN predicts, he would be in a league of his own with a mandate to craft a New Indian Republic. ■

Methodology

The INDIA TODAY Mood of the Nation (MOTN) poll was conducted by CVoter, a globally renowned name in the field of socio-economic research, between December 15, 2023, and January 28, 2024, interviewing 35,801 respondents covering all Lok Sabha segments across all states. In addition to these samples, 113,081 interviews from CVoter's regular tracker data between August 15, 2023, and January 31, 2024, were also analysed for the long-term trendline in calculating vote share and seat projections. Thus, the opinion of a total of 149,092 respondents was considered for this MOTN report. The margin of error is +/- 3 per cent at the macro level and +/- 5 per cent at the micro level of reporting, with 95 per cent confidence level.

From May 2009 onwards, the CVoter Tracker has been carried out each week, 52 waves in a calendar year, in 11 national languages, across all states and UTs in India, with a target sample size of 30,000 each quarter. The average response rate is 55 per cent. Starting January 1, 2019, CVoter has been carrying the tracker daily, using the rollover sample of seven days for tracker analysis.

All these polls are based on a random probability sample as used in the globally standardised methodology, carried out by trained researchers across all geographic and demographic segments. This survey is based on CATI interviews of adult respondents across all segments. Standard RDD is used to draw random numbers covering all frequency series allocated to all operators across all telecom circles in India.

CVoter ensures proper representative analysis by statistical weighing of the data to make it representative of the local population as per the latest Census figures. The data is weighted to the known census profile, including gender, age, education, income, religion, caste, urban/rural and vote recalls for the last Lok Sabha and Vidhan Sabha elections. For the analytics, CVoter uses its proprietary algorithm to calculate the provincial and regional vote share based on the split-voter phenomenon.

CVoter follows the code of professional ethics and practices drafted by the World Association of Public Opinion Research and the official guidelines on opinion polling as instructed by the Press Council of India.